

Reform Democrats of the New Commonwealth · Project ARA 2028
Legislative Ecosystem Document Leg03 of Leg14

Infrastructure & Industrial Capacity Act of 2027

Bill Framework & Legislative Brief

Phase I · Track A · Budget Reconciliation Vehicle · Phase I · Track A · Months 6–24

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This document is a policy discussion framework and bill scaffold. It is not formally introduced legislation, has not been reviewed by licensed legislative counsel, and does not constitute legal advice of any kind.

All provisions marked [TBD] — including dollar amounts, specific IRC section numbers, penalty thresholds, appropriation amounts, and CBO scoring figures — require resolution by licensed legislative drafting counsel (the Office of Legislative Counsel for the House or Senate, as applicable), relevant agency technical staff, and the Congressional Budget Office before introduction as formal legislation.

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Phase I · Track A · Budget Reconciliation Vehicle · Bill 2

Part I — Legislative Brief (Non-Technical Summary)

Designed for staffers, coalition partners, journalists, and elected officials. Explains what this bill does, why it uses the legislative vehicle it does, who benefits, and how to defend it.

AT A GLANCE	
Bill Title	Infrastructure & Industrial Capacity Act of 2027
Short Title (Cite As)	The IIC Act of 2027
Legislative Vehicle	Budget Reconciliation (simple Senate majority)
Phase / Track	Phase I · Track A — Months 6–24
Primary Committees	Ways & Means; Energy & Commerce; Transportation & Infrastructure; Armed Services

Dependencies	Bill 1 (COLT Act) political momentum; preferably passed in same reconciliation package
Core Framing	Jobs + Supply chain resilience + National security
Deficit Impact	Structured for neutrality within 10-year budget window via ROI-positive investments
Byrd Rule Status	All provisions carry direct budget impact — reconciliation eligible

What This Bill Does:

Four investments, each framed around national security and job creation — the two arguments that survive the widest range of political opposition:

- 1. Modernizes the national energy grid and accelerates domestic clean energy production** — solar, wind, hydroelectric, and nuclear. Frames this explicitly as grid security and energy independence, not environmental policy.
- 2. Funds domestic semiconductor fabrication and next-generation battery manufacturing.** These are national security assets — dependence on foreign supply chains for the components that run every weapons system, communication network, and critical infrastructure element is a documented strategic vulnerability.
- 3. Modernizes airports and the USPS delivery network.** These are job-dense, geographically distributed investments that produce visible, local improvements — exactly the kind of tangible benefit that builds Phase I political capital.
- 4. Dramatically expands the federal inspector and auditor workforce.** Corporations have systematically defunded the agencies that regulate them. Inspectors are the mechanism by which every other regulatory law becomes real. This provision is the accountability infrastructure that makes the rest of the RDNC agenda enforceable.

Why Reconciliation:

All four investment areas carry direct, scoreable budget impact — capital expenditures, workforce appropriations, and revenue effects from grid modernization and enforcement recovery. The national security framing is not rhetorical — it is legally relevant, as defense-adjacent spending has historically received broader reconciliation latitude. Ideally this bill is packaged in the same reconciliation vehicle as Bill 1 (COLT Act) to reduce procedural exposure.

Who Benefits:

- **American workers:** construction, manufacturing, logistics, and inspection jobs — geographically distributed and impossible to offshore.
- **Domestic manufacturers:** semiconductor and battery investment reduces input costs and supply chain vulnerability for every industry that depends on these components.
- **Rural and suburban communities:** energy grid modernization and airport investment are not coastal priorities — they are evenly distributed infrastructure upgrades.
- **The enforcement ecosystem:** inspector expansion restores the capacity to enforce existing law across every sector — food safety, financial markets, environmental standards, workplace safety.
- **Long-term fiscal position:** infrastructure investment has documented positive returns to GDP. Grid modernization reduces energy costs. Enforcement expansion pays for itself in recovered revenue and penalties.

ATTACK SURFACE	"Too expensive." "Government picking winners." "Green energy mandate." These are the three predictable lines. All are pre-answerable with the national security frame.
DEFENSE STRATEGY	"We are building what China and our adversaries are building. We cannot outsource the components that power our military, our hospitals, and our grid." Lead with semiconductor and battery manufacturing — hardest to attack as frivolous. Energy investment follows as grid security, not climate policy. Inspector expansion is framed as fraud reduction and cost savings, not bureaucracy.
FALLBACK POSITION	If the full bill faces Byrd Rule challenges, semiconductor and battery investment + inspector expansion are the most defensible core — both have clear, direct budget impact and the strongest national security rationale. Energy grid and USPS modernization can be separated into executive action or a subsequent standalone bill.

Sequencing Note: This bill is most powerful when passed in the same reconciliation package as Bill 1 (COLT Act). Together they deliver three immediate, tangible benefits: lower tax friction, lower childcare costs, and visible infrastructure investment in communities across the country. Passed separately, each is defensible. Passed together, they constitute a governing statement.

Part II — Bill Framework

This is the structural scaffold of the bill. Dollar amounts, specific agency allocations, and CBO scoring are flagged as [TBD] — these require congressional counsel, relevant agency technical staff, and CBO scoring before introduction. The framework below is ready for that conversion.

119TH CONGRESS 1ST SESSION H. R. ____

To provide for reconciliation pursuant to the concurrent resolution on the budget; to modernize domestic energy infrastructure and supply chains; to invest in domestic semiconductor and battery manufacturing capacity; to modernize federal transportation and delivery infrastructure; to expand federal enforcement and accountability capacity; and for other purposes.

A B I L L

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SEC. 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the "Infrastructure and Industrial Capacity Act of 2027" or the "IIC Act of 2027".

SEC. 2. FINDINGS AND PURPOSE.

(a) FINDINGS.—Congress finds the following:

- (1) The United States electrical grid operates on aging infrastructure with significant vulnerability to cyberattack, extreme weather, and cascading failure.
- (2) Domestic semiconductor manufacturing capacity has declined from approximately 37 percent of global production in 1990 to approximately 12 percent, creating documented supply chain vulnerabilities in defense, healthcare, and critical infrastructure systems.
- (3) Next-generation battery technology is a strategic national security asset underpinning domestic energy transition, military readiness, and supply chain resilience.

- (4) The Federal Aviation Administration has identified significant airport infrastructure deficits that reduce capacity and compromise safety margins.
- (5) The United States Postal Service requires capital investment in fleet electrification and delivery modernization to remain viable as a universal service provider.
- (6) Federal enforcement capacity across regulatory agencies has declined substantially, reducing the government's ability to detect fraud, recover revenue, and enforce existing law.
- (b) PURPOSE.—The purposes of this Act are to—
 - (1) modernize domestic energy infrastructure to reduce vulnerability and lower long-term costs;
 - (2) restore domestic manufacturing capacity in semiconductor and battery sectors essential to national security;
 - (3) modernize federal transportation and delivery infrastructure; and
 - (4) rebuild federal enforcement capacity to recover revenue, reduce fraud, and enforce existing statutory obligations.

SEC. 3. BUDGETARY COMPLIANCE.

- (a) RECONCILIATION.—The provisions of this Act are enacted pursuant to reconciliation instructions in the concurrent resolution on the budget for fiscal year 2027.
- (b) DEFICIT NEUTRALITY.—The provisions of this Act shall be implemented in a manner that does not increase the Federal deficit over the 10-year budget window, as determined by the Congressional Budget Office. Where capital investments produce long-term Federal revenue benefits, such benefits shall be counted toward budget neutrality in accordance with applicable CBO scoring rules.
- (c) BYRD RULE COMPLIANCE.—All provisions are designed to produce direct budgetary effects. Any provision determined by the Senate Parliamentarian to be extraneous under 2 U.S.C. §644 shall be severable from the remainder of the Act.

TITLE I — ENERGY GRID MODERNIZATION AND DOMESTIC CLEAN ENERGY

SEC. 101. GRID MODERNIZATION INVESTMENT FUND.

- (a) ESTABLISHMENT.—The Secretary of Energy shall establish a Grid Modernization Investment Fund to support capital investment in the resilience, security, and capacity of the domestic electrical grid.
- (b) APPROPRIATION.—\$[TBD] for each of fiscal years 2028 through 2035.
- (c) ELIGIBLE USES.—Funds shall be available for transmission line modernization and expansion; grid cybersecurity hardening and redundancy systems; distributed energy resource integration; grid-scale energy storage deployment; and interconnection upgrades between regional grid systems.
- (d) NATIONAL SECURITY DESIGNATION.—The Secretary shall coordinate with the Department of Defense and the Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency to ensure grid modernization activities funded under this section address identified national security vulnerabilities.

SEC. 102. DOMESTIC CLEAN ENERGY PRODUCTION INVESTMENT.

- (a) IN GENERAL.—The Secretary of Energy shall provide grants, loans, and loan guarantees for the development and expansion of domestic clean energy production facilities, including—
 - (1) solar manufacturing and installation;
 - (2) wind energy generation and component manufacturing;
 - (3) hydroelectric generation and modernization; and
 - (4) advanced nuclear energy development, including thorium-based and small modular reactor technologies.
- (b) DOMESTIC CONTENT REQUIREMENT.—Not less than [TBD] percent of components in federally-supported clean energy projects shall be manufactured in the United States.

(c) WORKFORCE REQUIREMENT.—Projects receiving support under this section shall pay prevailing wages as determined by the Secretary of Labor and shall utilize registered apprenticeship programs where available.

(d) APPROPRIATION.—\$[TBD] for fiscal years 2028 through 2035.

[Note to counsel: Sec 102(b) and (c) face Byrd Rule risk. Three-level fallback ladder documented in Part III. Brief Senate Budget staff on deliberate posture and prepared restructure language for Level 2 (IRA §§48/48E/45/45Y bonus credit conversion) if (b)/(c) struck.]

TITLE II — DOMESTIC SEMICONDUCTOR AND BATTERY MANUFACTURING

SEC. 201. SEMICONDUCTOR MANUFACTURING INVESTMENT PROGRAM.

(a) IN GENERAL.—The Secretary of Commerce shall establish a Domestic Semiconductor Manufacturing Investment Program to expand domestic fabrication capacity for semiconductors essential to defense, healthcare, and critical infrastructure systems.

(b) AUTHORIZED ACTIVITIES.—The Program shall provide direct grants for new or expanded fabrication facility construction; investment tax credits for qualifying capital expenditures; workforce development grants for semiconductor manufacturing skills training; and research and development grants for next-generation fabrication processes.

(c) DEFENSE COORDINATION.—The Secretary of Commerce shall coordinate with the Secretary of Defense to prioritize investment in semiconductor categories identified as critical defense supply chain vulnerabilities.

(d) ANTI-FOREIGN ADVERSARY PROVISION.—No entity substantially owned or controlled by a foreign adversary (as defined in applicable Federal law; see Part III for citation verification) shall be eligible for support under this section.

(e) APPROPRIATION.—\$[TBD] for fiscal years 2028 through 2035.

[Note to counsel: CHIPS Act (\$52.7B, Pub. L. 117-167, 2022) provides baseline. Counsel to assess additionality and coordination per Part III guidance.]

SEC. 202. NEXT-GENERATION BATTERY MANUFACTURING PROGRAM.

(a) IN GENERAL.—The Secretary of Energy shall establish a Next-Generation Battery Manufacturing Program to expand domestic production of advanced battery technologies for energy storage, transportation, and defense applications.

(b) AUTHORIZED ACTIVITIES.—The Program shall support manufacturing facility construction and expansion; materials processing and supply chain development; battery recycling and second-life technology; and workforce training for battery manufacturing.

(c) ALLIED NATION COORDINATION.—The Secretary shall pursue cooperative agreements with allied nations to develop resilient battery material supply chains that reduce dependence on foreign adversary sources.

(d) APPROPRIATION.—\$[TBD] for fiscal years 2028 through 2035.

TITLE III — TRANSPORTATION AND DELIVERY INFRASTRUCTURE

SEC. 301. AIRPORT MODERNIZATION PROGRAM.

(a) IN GENERAL.—The Secretary of Transportation shall establish an Airport Modernization Program to fund capital investment in domestic airport infrastructure.

(b) ELIGIBLE PROJECTS.—Grants under this section shall be available for terminal modernization and capacity expansion; runway and taxiway rehabilitation; air traffic control facility upgrades; ground transportation integration improvements; and accessibility and passenger experience upgrades.

(c) AIR TRAFFIC CONTROLLER WORKFORCE.—The Administrator of the Federal Aviation Administration shall develop and implement a plan to hire and train not fewer than [TBD] additional certified air traffic controllers over the 5-year period following enactment.

(d) APPROPRIATION.—\$[TBD] for fiscal years 2028 through 2033.

SEC. 302. UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE MODERNIZATION.

- (a) FLEET ELECTRIFICATION.—The Postmaster General shall develop and implement a plan for the electrification of the USPS delivery vehicle fleet, including acquisition of electric delivery vehicles; installation of charging infrastructure at postal facilities; and workforce training for electric vehicle maintenance.
- (b) DELIVERY NETWORK MODERNIZATION.—The Postmaster General shall invest in next-generation sorting, tracking, and delivery systems to maintain USPS competitiveness as a universal service provider.
- (c) BUDGET RESTORATION.—\$[TBD] appropriated to the USPS to restore operating capacity reduced by prior administrative actions, subject to a modernization plan approved by the Postal Regulatory Commission.
- (d) APPROPRIATION.—\$[TBD] for fiscal years 2028 through 2033.

TITLE IV – FEDERAL ENFORCEMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY CAPACITY

SEC. 401. FEDERAL INSPECTOR AND AUDITOR WORKFORCE EXPANSION.

- (a) IN GENERAL.—The heads of covered agencies shall expand the inspector, auditor, and enforcement workforce to levels sufficient to fulfill each agency's statutory enforcement obligations, under existing OPM competitive service hiring authorities (5 U.S.C. §3301 et seq.).
- (b) COVERED AGENCIES.—For purposes of this section, covered agencies include—
 - (1) the Environmental Protection Agency;
 - (2) the Food and Drug Administration;
 - (3) the Occupational Safety and Health Administration;
 - (4) the Securities and Exchange Commission;
 - (5) the Commodity Futures Trading Commission;
 - (6) the Federal Trade Commission; and
 - (7) such other agencies as the Director of the Office of Management and Budget identifies as having significant enforcement capacity deficits.
- (c) WORKFORCE TARGETS.—Each covered agency head shall, within 180 days of enactment, submit to Congress an enforcement capacity assessment, establish a 5-year workforce expansion target, and publish annual enforcement activity reports including penalties assessed, penalties collected, and revenue recovery attributable to enforcement activities.
- (d) APPROPRIATION.—\$[TBD] for each of fiscal years 2028 through 2033 for covered agencies to carry out this section.

[Note to counsel: Enforcement expansion is self-funding over the budget window – CBO to score enforcement revenue recovery as budget offset. Sec 401(c) workforce targets and reporting function as terms and conditions of (d) outlay; if struck, (d) appropriation alone survives with reporting/targets re-imposed administratively by OMB. See Part III for fallback structure.]

SEC. 402. INSPECTOR GENERAL INDEPENDENCE AND CAPACITY.

- (a) IN GENERAL.—\$[TBD] appropriated to the Council of the Inspectors General on Integrity and Efficiency (CIGIE) to expand Inspector General office capacity across the Federal Government.
- (b) INDEPENDENCE PROTECTIONS.—No appropriation under this section may be conditioned on any requirement that an Inspector General submit findings for prior executive review before transmission to Congress.
- (c) REPORTING.—Each Inspector General receiving funds under this section shall submit an annual report to Congress including total fraud and waste identified, total funds recovered, and enforcement referrals made and outcomes.

TITLE V – IMPLEMENTATION

SEC. 501. IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE.

- (a) YEAR 1 (2028).—Grid Modernization Fund operational; Semiconductor Program accepting

applications; Airport Modernization grants awarded (first round); USPS electrification plan submitted; agency enforcement capacity assessments submitted to Congress.

(b) YEAR 3 (2030).—First domestic semiconductor facilities operational; grid modernization milestone review; enforcement workforce at 50 percent of 5-year target; USPS fleet electrification at [TBD] percent.

(c) YEAR 5 (2032).—Comprehensive program review and reauthorization assessment; enforcement workforce at 100 percent of targets; GDP and employment impact assessment.

Part III — Notes for Congressional Counsel

The following items require resolution by relevant agency technical staff and congressional counsel before introduction.

Item Requiring Resolution	Guidance
Sec 102 wage/apprenticeship + domestic-content mandates — deliberate posture with three-level fallback ladder [Source 271]	Sec 102 carries two provisions Group G research identifies as Byrd-exposed: Sec 102(b) domestic content requirement and Sec 102(c) prevailing-wage and apprenticeship mandate. Both are retained as primary bill text because the labor-standards and domestic-content signaling carries political value beyond their structural Byrd survival. The bill is structured around a three-level fallback ladder so that program continuity and policy substance survive even if (b) and (c) are struck. (1) Primary structure. Sec 102(b) domestic content + Sec 102(c) prevailing-wage and apprenticeship requirements operate as conditions on federally-supported clean energy projects. Sec 102(d) \$[TBD] mandatory appropriation provides the direct revenue effect anchoring all four subsections. Conditions on (a)–(c) function as terms and conditions of the (d) outlay rather than free-standing regulatory mandates. MacDonough's current-policy-baseline reasoning [Source 271] in the June–July 2025 OBBBA proceedings provides additional support where prior-Congress IRA structure is the reference baseline. (2) Mid-level fallback if Sec 102(b) and/or (c) are struck. Restructure surviving content as IRA §§48/48E/45/45Y bonus credit architecture: domestic content + Davis-Bacon compliance unlock a higher tax credit rate rather than operating as mandates. This is the structurally cleanest path Group G research identifies — IRA §§48/48E/45/45Y bonus credits SURVIVED the 2022 Byrd bath as tax credits with direct revenue effects (meeting or failing the threshold changes tax liability directly). Conversion preserves both labor-standards and domestic-content policy substance with the Byrd posture changed to credits-with-eligibility-thresholds rather than grants-with-mandates. Counsel should have Level 2 restructure language drafted and ready before introduction. (3) Bottom-level fallback if Sec 102 is struck wholesale. The Sec 102(d) appropriation alone is Byrd-safe — direct mandatory appropriation for clean energy production under existing DOE statutory authority (Energy Policy Act, 42 U.S.C. §16231 et seq.). If (a)–(c) are removed by Parliamentary challenge, the surviving appropriation funds the program operationally. Domestic-content and wage standards would then be re-imposed administratively by DOE in grant award terms and conditions — the post-IRA Yellen-letter pattern after the IRS Strategic Operating Plan mandate strike. The clean-energy investment program continues operationally even if statutory direction is lost. (4) Parliamentary engagement. Pre-introduction Byrd letter from Senate Budget Committee staff required. Sec 102(c) prevailing-wage and apprenticeship mandate is the most exposed provision under ARPA \$15 minimum wage precedent — counsel should request advisory ruling on (c) specifically, with prepared (b)→(c) restructure language ready for a Level 2 conversion if needed. Sec 102(a) clean energy authority and Sec 102(d) appropriation are anticipated to survive together. This is a defensible posture, not an automatic Byrd-safe path — brief counsel and committee staff on the deliberate trade and the prepared fallback architecture.

Item Requiring Resolution	Guidance
Grid modernization appropriation (Sec. 101) — direct appropriation, Byrd-safe	Direct mandatory appropriation to DOE grid programs under existing FPA (16 U.S.C. §824) and Energy Act (42 U.S.C. §16231) authority is Byrd-safe. BIL (2021) invested \$65B in grid — cite the infrastructure gap. Avoid creating new regulatory frameworks or DOE rulemaking mandates in the reconciliation vehicle; operate under existing DOE authority after appropriation. CBO to score long-term revenue benefits from reduced outage costs and increased grid efficiency.
Clean energy production appropriation (Sec. 102) — IRA additionality	IRA (2022) provides \$369B baseline for clean energy production. Counsel to assess additionality carefully: supplement, do not duplicate IRA credit mechanisms. Battery manufacturing (Sec. 202): structure as grants for manufacturing capacity (direct appropriation) rather than tax credits to avoid duplicating IRA §45X manufacturing credit. Where IIC clean energy provisions overlap with IRA, frame as supplements to existing Title 26 authority rather than parallel new mechanisms.
Inspector workforce appropriation (Sec. 401) — direct appropriation structure [Source 271]	NEW: The OBBBA 2025 Byrd bath [Source 271] confirms that direct mandatory appropriations to agency staffing under EXISTING OPM hiring authorities are Byrd-safe; novel inspectorate architectures with new definitions, titles, and governance are at risk. REQUIRED STRUCTURE: appropriate funds directly to covered-agency Inspector workforce under existing OPM competitive service authorities (5 U.S.C. §3301 et seq.). Do NOT create a new Inspector General-type body or a new Inspector category with statutory duties and pay structures — that architecture faces merely-incidental Byrd analysis. Sec 401(c) workforce targets and reporting function as terms and conditions of (d) outlay; if struck, the appropriation continues with reporting/targets re-imposed administratively by OMB. OMB agency-by-agency capacity deficit assessment and CBO enforcement-revenue-recovery scoring as budget offset are required.
Semiconductor appropriation (Sec. 201)	CHIPS Act (\$52.7B, Pub. L. 117-167, 2022) is the precedent. CHIPS was non-reconciliation by deliberate choice — its programmatic architecture (eligibility criteria, guardrails, workforce requirements) cannot survive Byrd. For IIC: appropriate funds directly to the existing CHIPS program (15 U.S.C. §4652) as a supplement. Target defense-critical categories not fully covered by original CHIPS allocation. DoD supply chain assessment required. Avoid recreating CHIPS programmatic architecture; supplement existing program.
Airport and USPS appropriations (Secs. 301, 302)	Airport (Sec. 301): estimate \$10–15B in unmet airport capital needs under existing FAA Airport Improvement Program (49 U.S.C. §47101 et seq.). ATC workforce plan to be developed with FAA Administrator under existing FAA authority. USPS (Sec. 302): Postal Regulatory Commission to certify modernization plan before funds released — prevents funds being used to reverse prior service reductions rather than modernize. ARPA 2021 USPS electrification appropriation precedent supports Byrd survival. Both are direct appropriations with clean Byrd profiles if structured without new programmatic mandates.

Item Requiring Resolution	Guidance
Anti-foreign-adversary citation verification (Sec. 201(d))	Counsel to verify the operative cross-reference for the foreign-adversary definition. Multiple potentially applicable statutes exist post-2024: Secure and Trusted Communications Networks Act (47 U.S.C. §1608), Foreign Adversary Communications Reporting Act, Section 1758 of NDAA, and EO 14034 framework. Office of Legislative Counsel resolution required before introduction; align with controlling export control regime in force at time of drafting.
Byrd Rule certification — OBBBA 2025 controlling [Source 271]	The OBBBA Byrd bath (July 2025) [Source 271] is the most current precedent. IIC is at risk on any provision that: (a) creates new regulatory architectures (new inspectorate, new domestic-content enforcement mechanism, new USPS or FAA program frameworks); (b) includes policy conditions on infrastructure grants that outweigh the budget effect; or (c) duplicates existing IRA credit mechanisms in a way the Parliamentarian characterizes as redundant. What survived OBBBA: all IRA-model tax credits; direct appropriations to existing agency accounts. What was struck: REINS Act, EPA passenger-vehicle emissions repeal, NEPA fee-for-bypass — all regulatory policy dressed as budget. Keep IIC provisions as direct appropriations to existing agency accounts under existing statutory authority. Senate Parliamentarian contact (pre-introduction) and bills-committee staff review required for each provision.
Packaging with Bill 1 (COLT Act)	Strong preference is single reconciliation package with COLT. If packaged separately, introduce in same reconciliation window. Combined reconciliation package should be reviewed as a unified Byrd submission — interactions between IIC and COLT provisions can create unintended Byrd exposure if scored separately. Both bills carry deliberate Byrd-exposure postures (COLT Direct File mandate; IIC Sec 102 wage/content mandates) — combined Parliamentarian engagement should address both as a deliberate institutional pattern, not isolated bets.
CBO cost estimate	Required before introduction. Full score including: grid modernization revenue benefits (reduced outage costs, increased efficiency); semiconductor and battery manufacturing supply-chain offsets; airport and USPS infrastructure benefits; enforcement revenue recovery (Title IV ROI). Note: infrastructure investment CBO methodology often understates long-term GDP benefits. Counsel to request dynamic scoring supplement capturing GDP, employment, and supply-chain resilience effects.

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Originally conceived and authored by a concerned American citizen. Developed with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic). The ideas belong to anyone willing to fight for them.